

Face ID or Touch ID in order to open the app, even when your smartphone is unlocked. Android users, on the other hand, can enable 'Unlock with Fingerprint'. Do note that you will still be able to reply from the notifications itself and answer calls even if WhatsApp is locked. However, this protects your chats from being read by unwanted spying eyes, in general.

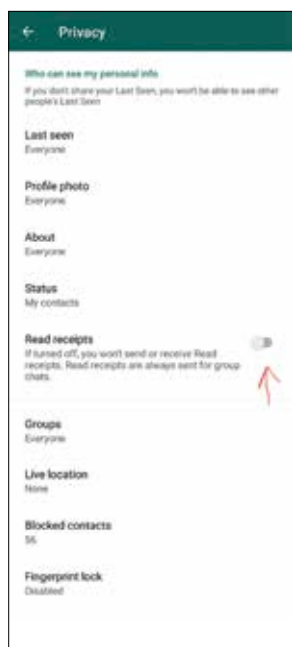
For iOS, head over to WhatsApp Settings > Account > Privacy > Screen Lock. Now, toggle on Require Face ID/ Require Touch ID. You can set a time duration for the app to be locked as well - immediately, after 1 minute, after 15 minutes, or after 1 hour. For Android devices, head over to WhatsApp Settings > Account > Privacy > Fingerprint lock. Now, toggle it on and enter your fingerprint once to confirm this.



TURN OFF BLUE TICKS AND LAST SEEN

If you detest blue ticks and the world of trouble they can get you in, you can simply turn this polarising feature off. However, it's worth noting that you won't get read receipts for your messages either if you do opt to turn blue ticks (read receipts) off. The feature can be turned off by going to Set-

tings > Account > Privacy. Now, either toggle it off (iOS) or untick it (Android). Here's another pro tip for iOS users. If you simply get Siri to read out your WhatsApp messages, the blue ticks won't appear at all. So, just in case you're trying to avoid giving off your read receipt to the sender but still want to know what the message says, this is a safe way to do it. Or else, you could just read the message in the notification bar itself. No one has to know.



Similarly, you can also turn off your last seen if you simply don't want your contacts knowing when you last visited WhatsApp. If a contact hasn't disabled last seen, it can be seen under their name at the top of the chat. This can be a giveaway if you're trying to avoid someone's messages since they will be able to see that you have opened the app but haven't responded to them. To disable this feature, head over to Settings > Account > Privacy > Last Seen. Now, select 'Nobody' in the list of options.



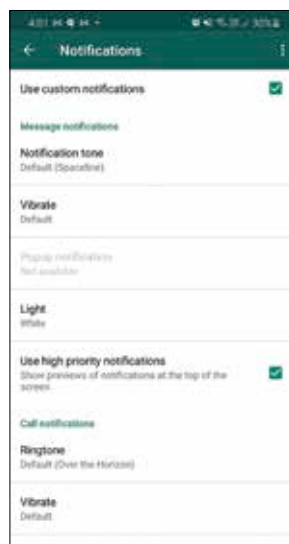
REPLY TO A GROUP MESSAGE PRIVATELY

If you want to reply to a message someone sent on a WhatsApp group, but on private chat instead, you can do that. Sure, you can just head over to the private chat you have with the individual but that won't give you the inline reply that you get if you just follow these steps. Inline replies (where your reply has the text you're replying to on top of it) are convenient and allow people to immediately see the context of your message. This is especially important in group chats where messages are aplenty and they can get chaotic. To do this on iOS, press and hold the message you want to reply to in a group chat > Select More > Reply privately. On Android, press and hold the message in the group chat > Select the three dots in the top right corner > Reply Privately.

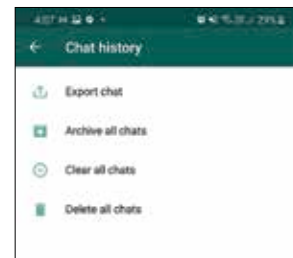


CUSTOM NOTIFICATIONS

If you want to set custom notification tones for certain contacts that you want to stand out from the crowd, there's a way to easily do



that on WhatsApp. You can change that contact's alert tone so you can recognise when they are calling or texting you on WhatsApp. To do this, head over to the



specific chat that you want to customise the notification tones for and then tap on the contact's name on the top of the screen. Now, select Custom Notifications and you can change the message and call alerts right here. You can also change the duration of the vibration over here, from Off, to Default, Short or Long.



EMAIL YOUR CHAT LOGS

WhatsApp allows you to back up your chat history for easy retrieval on the cloud. However, if you want to send a specific chat log to someone, you can choose to email the chat log via WhatsApp. In order to do this, head over to WhatsApp Settings > Chats > Chat History. Now, tap on 'Export Chat'. Your chat menu will pop up and you can select the chat you want to export. Once you've chosen the desired chat, select if you'd like the log to be sent with or without media (photos, videos, voice recordings, etc). Now, you will be directed to a share menu where you can choose to send the chat over email. The chat log will be attached to an email draft in .txt format and you can simply send it to whoever you desire. **4**